

# Chapter 25 - IE32

IE32 is the 32-bit predecessor of IE64. It uses the same memory bus, sees the same MMIO map, and has the same fixed-length encoding. The differences are entirely about size and complexity: IE32 has half-width registers, fewer of them, no MMU, no FPU, and a simpler instruction set.

For programs that fit in 4 gigabytes of address space and do not need floating-point or virtual memory, IE32 is faster to write for and easier to read back.

## 25.1 Register file

IE32 names its 16 general-purpose registers with letters rather than numbers:

| Register                           | Role                                                  |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| A                                  | Accumulator. Default destination for most arithmetic. |
| X, Y, Z                            | Index registers. Used for addressing and counters.    |
| B, C, D, E, F, G, H, S, T, U, V, W | General purpose.                                      |
| PC                                 | Program counter (32 bits, not addressable as a GPR).  |
| SP                                 | Stack pointer (32 bits, not addressable as a GPR).    |

Each register holds one 32-bit unsigned value. Signed operations interpret the same bits as two's-complement.

There is no zero register on IE32. Code that needs the constant zero loads it into a free register or uses the addressing mode's immediate form.

## 25.2 Instruction encoding

Every IE32 instruction is 8 bytes long:

```
byte 0 : opcode          (8 bits)
byte 1 : register field   (8 bits - low 4 bits = register index)
byte 2 : addressing mode  (8 bits)
byte 3 : reserved        (8 bits)
bytes 4-7 : operand       (32 bits)
```

The operand interpretation depends on the addressing mode. Word alignment is required for jump and call targets.

## 25.3 Addressing modes

| Code | Mode              | Operand meaning                                           |
|------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| \$00 | Immediate         | Operand is the literal value                              |
| \$01 | Register direct   | Operand is a register index                               |
| \$02 | Register indirect | Operand is a register holding the address                 |
| \$03 | Memory indirect   | Operand is the address of an address (double indirection) |

| Code | Mode   | Operand meaning               |
|------|--------|-------------------------------|
| \$04 | Direct | Operand is the memory address |

For example, LDA #\$42 (immediate) loads \$42 into A; LDA \$F0700 (direct) loads from address \$F0700; LDA (X) (register indirect) loads from the address in X.

## 25.4 Instruction set

### 25.4.1 Data movement

LOAD / STORE are the generic forms. The letter-suffixed forms target specific registers:

| Mnemonic             | Operation                                   |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| LDA/LDX/LDY/LDZ      | Load A/X/Y/Z from operand                   |
| LDB-LDW, LDH/LDS/LDT | Load extended register                      |
| STA/STX/STY/STZ      | Store A/X/Y/Z to operand                    |
| STB-STW, STH/STS/STT | Store extended register                     |
| INC reg              | Increment a register (or memory in operand) |
| DEC reg              | Decrement a register (or memory in operand) |

### 25.4.2 Arithmetic and logic

ADD, SUB, MUL, DIV, MOD, AND, OR, XOR, NOT, SHL, SHR. Each takes a register operand and an addressing-mode operand; the result lands in the named register.

Example: ADD A, X adds the value in X to A. ADD A, #5 adds an immediate 5 to A.

### 25.4.3 Control flow

IE32 has no flags. Conditional jumps test the named register directly:

| Mnemonic      | Branches if       |
|---------------|-------------------|
| JMP           | unconditional     |
| JZ reg, addr  | reg == 0          |
| JNZ reg, addr | reg != 0          |
| JGT reg, addr | reg > 0 (signed)  |
| JGE reg, addr | reg >= 0 (signed) |
| JLT reg, addr | reg < 0 (signed)  |
| JLE reg, addr | reg <= 0 (signed) |

The signed sense of JGT/JGE/JLT/JLE matters: a value of \$FFFFFFFF is treated as -1 by these instructions, so JLT A, addr branches when A has its high bit set.

A typical comparison sequence is:

```
SUB A, X      ; A = A - X
JGT A, label  ; branch if A > X
```

#### 25.4.4 Subroutines

| Mnemonic | Operation                                       |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------|
| JSR addr | Push PC + 8 to the stack, jump to addr          |
| RTS      | Pop a return address from the stack, jump there |
| PUSH reg | SP -= 4; [SP] = reg                             |
| POP reg  | reg = [SP]; SP += 4                             |

The stack grows downward. The reset SP is `STACK_START = $9F000`.

#### 25.4.5 System

| Mnemonic | Operation                       |
|----------|---------------------------------|
| NOP      | No operation                    |
| HALT     | Halt the CPU                    |
| SEI      | Set the interrupt-enable flag   |
| CLI      | Clear the interrupt-enable flag |
| RTI      | Return from interrupt           |
| WAIT n   | Wait n cycles                   |

### 25.5 Interrupts and timing

IE32 has a single interrupt vector at memory `$0004`. When an interrupt fires:

1. PC is pushed to the stack.
2. The interrupt-enable flag is cleared.
3. PC is loaded from `$0004`.

RTI reverses the sequence: pops PC and re-enables interrupts.

IE32 publishes no timer MMIO block. Use `WAIT n` for short cycle delays, and use device status registers or interrupts for frame, audio, and I/O timing.

### 25.6 Reset and boot

On reset, `PC = $0000` and `SP = STACK_START = $9F000`. The conventional first instruction at `$0000` is a `JMP` to `PROG_START = $1000`, the usual start address for byte-entered IE32 programs and loaded IE32 images.

### 25.7 A small example

This IE32 byte-entry program plays a three-channel chord through the SN76489. IE32 stores 32-bit words, and the SN76489 write port uses the low byte of each word as the chip's byte-stream input. That makes the example a good first

bus exercise: every STA is a word store, but the sound chip hears a single command byte.

```
(ie32)> w 1000 20 00 00 00 01 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 08 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1010 20 00 00 00 8B 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1020 20 00 00 00 1A 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1030 20 00 00 00 90 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1040 20 00 00 00 A3 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1050 20 00 00 00 15 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1060 20 00 00 00 B2 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1070 20 00 00 00 CD 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1080 20 00 00 00 11 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1090 20 00 00 00 D3 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00
(ie32)> w 10A0 06 00 00 00 A0 10 00 00
(ie32)> d 1000 21
1000: 20 00 00 00 01 00 00 00 LDA A, #$00000001
1008: 24 00 04 00 00 08 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0800
1010: 20 00 00 00 8B 00 00 00 LDA A, #$0000008B
1018: 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0C30
1020: 20 00 00 00 1A 00 00 00 LDA A, #$0000001A
1028: 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0C30
1030: 20 00 00 00 90 00 00 00 LDA A, #$00000090
1038: 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0C30
1040: 20 00 00 00 A3 00 00 00 LDA A, #$000000A3
1048: 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0C30
1050: 20 00 00 00 15 00 00 00 LDA A, #$00000015
1058: 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0C30
1060: 20 00 00 00 B2 00 00 00 LDA A, #$000000B2
1068: 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0C30
1070: 20 00 00 00 CD 00 00 00 LDA A, #$000000CD
1078: 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0C30
1080: 20 00 00 00 11 00 00 00 LDA A, #$00000011
1088: 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0C30
1090: 20 00 00 00 D3 00 00 00 LDA A, #$000000D3
1098: 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 STA A, M:$000F0C30
10A0: 06 00 00 00 A0 10 00 00 JMP $000010A0
(ie32)> r pc 1000
(ie32)> b 10A0
(ie32)> g
(ie32)> m F0C31 1
F0C31: 01
(ie32)> bc 10A0
```

The instruction format makes each 8-byte group readable once the mode byte is known:

| Address | Bytes                   | Meaning                                                                                                                  |
|---------|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$1000  | 20 00 00 00 01 00 00 00 | LDA A,#1. Opcode \$20 is LDA; register byte \$00 selects A; mode \$00 is immediate; operand is little-endian \$00000001. |
| \$1008  | 24 00 04 00 00 08 0F 00 | STA A,M:\$000F0800. Opcode \$24 is STA; mode \$04 is direct memory. This writes AUDIO_CTRL.                              |
| \$1010  | 20 00 00 00 8B 00 00 00 | Loads the SN76489 channel 0 tone latch byte \$8B into A.                                                                 |
| \$1018  | 24 00 04 00 30 0C 0F 00 | Stores the low byte of A to \$F0C30, the SN76489 byte-stream port.                                                       |

| Address       | Bytes                      | Meaning                                                        |
|---------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$1020        | 20 00 00 00 1A 00<br>00 00 | Loads the channel 0 tone high-byte payload \$1A.               |
| \$1028        | 24 00 04 00 30 0C<br>0F 00 | Sends that payload through the same port.                      |
| \$1030        | 20 00 00 00 90 00<br>00 00 | Loads attenuation latch \$90, channel 0 at full volume.        |
| \$1038        | 24 00 04 00 30 0C<br>0F 00 | Sends the attenuation latch.                                   |
| \$1040-\$1068 | Six instructions           | Sends channel 1: latch \$A3, high byte \$15, attenuation \$B2. |
| \$1070-\$1098 | Six instructions           | Sends channel 2: latch \$CD, high byte \$11, attenuation \$D3. |
| \$10A0        | 06 00 00 00 A0 10<br>00 00 | JMP \$000010A0, a self-loop that leaves the chord active.      |

The first two instructions enable audio by writing 1 to AUDIO\_CTRL. The final dump reads SN\_PORT\_READY, which returns bit 0 set when the byte-stream port can accept another byte. The SN76489 divider is  $\text{clock} / (32 * \text{Hz})$ . At the NTSC clock, useful musical dividers are about \$1AB for C, \$153 for E, and \$11D for G. The latch byte carries the channel number and the low four divider bits; the following data byte carries the upper six bits. \$90, \$B2, and \$D3 are attenuation latches for channels 0, 1, and 2; lower attenuation is louder.

Try changing \$B2 to \$B0 and run again. That makes the middle voice as loud as the root without changing the pitch bytes.

## 25.8 VGA text example

This second IE32 byte-entry program uses VGA text mode. It switches the VGA card to mode \$03, enables it, and writes the first four text cells at \$B8000. Each cell is two bytes: character, then attribute. The attribute high nibble is the background colour and the low nibble is the foreground colour.

```

(ie32)> w 1100 20 00 00 00 03 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 10 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1110 20 00 00 00 01 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 08 10 0F 00
(ie32)> w 1120 20 00 00 00 49 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 80 0B 00
(ie32)> w 1130 20 00 00 00 1E 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 01 80 0B 00
(ie32)> w 1140 20 00 00 00 45 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 02 80 0B 00
(ie32)> w 1150 20 00 00 00 2F 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 03 80 0B 00
(ie32)> w 1160 20 00 00 00 33 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 04 80 0B 00
(ie32)> w 1170 20 00 00 00 4E 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 05 80 0B 00
(ie32)> w 1180 20 00 00 00 32 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 06 80 0B 00
(ie32)> w 1190 20 00 00 00 5F 00 00 00 24 00 04 00 00 07 80 0B 00
(ie32)> w 11A0 06 00 00 00 A0 11 00 00
(ie32)> d 1100 21
1100: 20 00 00 00 03 00 00 00   LDA A, #$00000003
1108: 24 00 04 00 00 10 0F 00   STA A, M:$000F1000
1110: 20 00 00 00 01 00 00 00   LDA A, #$00000001
1118: 24 00 04 00 08 10 0F 00   STA A, M:$000F1008
1120: 20 00 00 00 49 00 00 00   LDA A, #$00000049
1128: 24 00 04 00 00 80 0B 00   STA A, M:$000B8000
1130: 20 00 00 00 1E 00 00 00   LDA A, #$0000001E
1138: 24 00 04 00 01 80 0B 00   STA A, M:$000B8001
1140: 20 00 00 00 45 00 00 00   LDA A, #$00000045
1148: 24 00 04 00 02 80 0B 00   STA A, M:$000B8002
1150: 20 00 00 00 2F 00 00 00   LDA A, #$0000002F
1158: 24 00 04 00 03 80 0B 00   STA A, M:$000B8003
1160: 20 00 00 00 33 00 00 00   LDA A, #$00000033
1168: 24 00 04 00 04 80 0B 00   STA A, M:$000B8004
1170: 20 00 00 00 4E 00 00 00   LDA A, #$0000004E
1178: 24 00 04 00 05 80 0B 00   STA A, M:$000B8005
1180: 20 00 00 00 32 00 00 00   LDA A, #$00000032
1188: 24 00 04 00 06 80 0B 00   STA A, M:$000B8006
1190: 20 00 00 00 5F 00 00 00   LDA A, #$0000005F
1198: 24 00 04 00 07 80 0B 00   STA A, M:$000B8007
11A0: 06 00 00 00 A0 11 00 00   JMP $000011A0
(ie32)> r pc 1100
(ie32)> b 11A0
(ie32)> g
(ie32)> m B8000 8
B8000: 49 1E 45 2F 33 4E 32 5F
(ie32)> bc 11A0

```

The first four instructions set up the card: VGA\_MODE at \$F1000 gets mode \$03, and VGA\_CTRL at \$F1008 gets bit 0 set. After that, each pair of instructions writes one byte to the text buffer. IE32 stores a word, but the VGA text window uses the low byte at the address being written, so the program writes the character and attribute bytes separately.

The dump at \$B8000 is the proof. It reads as:

| Bytes | Meaning                               |
|-------|---------------------------------------|
| 49 1E | Character I, yellow on blue.          |
| 45 2F | Character E, bright white on green.   |
| 33 4E | Character 3, yellow on red.           |
| 32 5F | Character 2, bright white on magenta. |

On the VGA layer, the top-left of the screen should show IE32 in four different attributes. Try changing the byte \$49 at \$1120 to \$56; the first character becomes V.

## 25.9 What comes next

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Chapter 26 leaves the IE-native processors behind and begins the heritage section: the 6502, the small 8-bit CPU that powered the home computers of the late 1970s and early 1980s. The 6502 has only three registers and a 64-kilobyte address space, but much of the software written for it is still beautiful to read, and Intuition Engine runs it natively.